

A first-120-day entry plan for enterprise AI adoption at SupplyHouse

OPERATING POSTURE

This plan is a starting hypothesis based on public information and the role description. It deliberately avoids pretending to know SupplyHouse's current AI portfolio, governance, budgets, data architecture or employee sentiment. The first phase exists to replace those hypotheses with evidence.

OBJECTIVES BY DAY 120

Shared direction

A clearly articulated enterprise AI adoption thesis connected to business objectives and employee experience.

Visible portfolio

A governed inventory of existing use, proposed use cases, owners, dependencies, risks and decision status.

Proven mechanism

Two bounded use cases commissioned with evidence, enablement and explicit human authority.

Installed capability

A practical CoE/ambassador rhythm, decision rights, measurement system and reusable pilot-to-pattern playbook.

PRINCIPLES

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT CHANGES
Listen before prescription	Workflow observation and employee signal precede tool selection.
Business ownership	Every use case has a functional owner accountable for outcomes and adoption.
Human authority by design	Decision, approval, override and escalation are explicit before launch.
Evidence before expansion	Scale follows quality, sustained use, confidence and business evidence.
Equitable enablement	Frontline and less technical teams receive usable access, practice and support.

FIRST-WEEK AGENDA

- Align with executive sponsor on decision rights, expectations, communication cadence and success narrative.
- Meet IT, Data Engineering, Legal/Compliance, HR, Finance, Operations, Sales, Procurement and Customer Service leaders.
- Ask each leader for one valuable workflow, one feared failure and one prior change that teams adopted well.
- Spend time with frontline employees and managers using current systems and informal workarounds.
- Inventory existing AI tools, vendor commitments, pilots, data boundaries, governance and enablement assets.

Days 0-30 · Read the work

Replace assumptions with an operating picture

QUESTIONS TO ANSWER

Business

- Which workflows constrain growth, service, margin or capacity?
- Where is value already visible?
- Which outcomes matter to the C-suite and Board?

People

- Where is curiosity high? Where is fear rational?
- Who are trusted informal teachers?
- Which teams have unequal access to tools or training?

Technology and risk

- What tools, data and vendor contracts already exist?
- What security, privacy, legal and model risks are non-negotiable?
- Who supports production use?

Adoption

- What changes have spread successfully?
- What pilots stalled, and why?
- How is usage and value currently measured?

ACTIVITIES

LISTEN

Executive, functional and frontline interviews

Use calibrated questions, workflow stories and skepticism as data.

OBSERVE

Gemba-style workflow walks

Follow actual work across systems, handoffs, exceptions and unofficial support paths.

MAP

AI portfolio and adoption landscape

Record use case, owner, user population, tool, data, authority, evidence and status.

BASELINE

Trust and readiness signals

Create an honest qualitative baseline without inventing a maturity score.

DELIVERABLES

- Enterprise AI context map: objectives, stakeholders, current initiatives, tensions and dependencies.
- AI use-case inventory with verified status and owner.
- Adoption signal report: confidence, access, change fatigue, champion candidates and enablement gaps.
- Draft decision-rights map covering business, IT, Data, Legal, HR and Finance.
- Candidate use-case shortlist with explicit assumptions and required discovery.

DAY-30 DECISION

Executive review: agree on two bounded use cases to commission, the evidence required, and what will explicitly not be attempted in the first 120 days.

Days 31-90 · Choose, commission and learn

Prove the adoption mechanism with bounded work

DAYS 31-60 · CHOOSE THE CIRCUITS

SELECT **Prioritize two use cases**

Favor credible value, available evidence, engaged owners, manageable risk and learning potential—not executive novelty.

COMMISSION **Complete the five-condition review**

Work value, data/control readiness, human authority, enablement and evidence.

DESIGN **Build the workflow and support system**

Define user journey, prompts/context, checkpoints, exceptions, owner, support and rollback.

PREPARE **Form a small ambassador cohort**

Recruit trusted users, practice real cases and refine language before broader launch.

DAYS 61-90 · RUN AND LEARN

Operating cadence

- Weekly pilot decision review
- Office hours and visible support
- Exception and failure log
- Rapid training updates

Evidence cadence

- Workflow baseline vs. observed result
- Quality and control review
- Usage depth, not just logins
- Confidence and access signal

ILLUSTRATIVE PILOT SCORECARD

QUESTION	SIGNAL	DECISION USE
Are people using it in the intended workflow?	Eligible users, frequency, depth, abandonment, workarounds	Adjust enablement, workflow fit or eligibility
Is it helping?	Cycle time, rework, quality, backlog, service or capacity	Validate or reject the value hypothesis
Is reliance appropriate?	Evaluation results, corrections, overrides, escalation	Tighten authority, controls or model behavior
Do users feel capable and safe?	Confidence, clarity of limits, access to help	Improve training, support and psychological safety
Can the pattern repeat?	Reusable components, stable data, support owner, known failure modes	Scale, hold, repair or stop

DAY-90 DECISION

For each pilot: scale, extend the evidence period, repair the workflow, narrow the use case or stop. A “stop” decision is useful learning, not a failed transformation.

Days 91-120 · Install the capability

Turn pilot learning into an enterprise operating system

INSTITUTIONALIZE WHAT WORKED

Center of Excellence

Define a small enabling core—not a central gatekeeping bureaucracy—with clear services, decision rights and response times.

Ambassador network

Create role-based champions with protected learning time, feedback pathways and recognition for teaching others.

Reusable playbook

Publish commissioning criteria, workflow templates, authority patterns, evaluation methods, enablement assets and escalation paths.

Executive scorecard

Report adoption, confidence, workflow, quality/risk, value and reusable learning without hiding assumptions.

DECISION-RIGHTS DRAFT

DECISION	ACCOUNTABLE OWNER	REQUIRED PARTNERS
Business outcome and workflow change	Functional executive / process owner	Frontline users, Finance, AI adoption team
Platform, integration and support	IT / Data leadership	Security, architecture, vendor, business owner
Privacy, legal and responsible-use boundaries	Legal / Compliance / Security	HR, Data, business owner, AI adoption team
Training, role expectations and career pathways	HR + functional leadership	Managers, ambassadors, AI adoption team
Scale / hold / stop investment	Executive sponsor / portfolio forum	Finance, business owner, IT, Legal, AI adoption team

DAY-120 EXECUTIVE REVIEW

- What did the pilots change in the work, and what evidence is still missing?
- Where did employee skepticism identify a real design problem?
- Which components, controls or enablement patterns are reusable?
- Which use cases should enter the next commissioning wave?
- What investment, team shape and vendor strategy are justified by the evidence?
- What should remain explicitly out of scope?

12-MONTH HORIZON

Desired state: AI adoption is no longer an event or tool campaign. It is a visible operating discipline: business-owned, technically supported, responsibly governed, role-enabled and measured by outcomes plus employee confidence.